

SS01 PROMOTE HEALTH AND WELL-BEING | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Promote adherence to collective well-being and sustainability goals and a deeper occupant understanding of the features pursued by the project and of how building operations and policies impact health and well-being.

Summary: This feature requires project teams to establish a health-oriented project mission and to provide a guide to occupants that highlights the features pursued by the project, the relationship between health and buildings and available health resources and programs.

Issue: Health literacy refers to a person's cognitive and social ability to access, interpret and understand basic health information, as well as the ability to act on that understanding to maintain health.^{242,250–252} Health literacy is influenced by sociocultural factors such as age, socioeconomic status, mental health, cultural background, language and communication abilities, prior health experiences and how healthcare delivery and education systems deliver care, health information and health education.²⁵⁰ Low health literacy is linked to lower use of preventive care (e.g., flu shots), poor management of chronic conditions (e.g., high blood pressure) and lower self-reported mental and physical health.^{253,254} Studies estimate that low health literacy costs the U.S. economy anywhere between \$70-240 billion each year.^{245,253}

Solutions: Establishing a health-centered mission and orienting stakeholders to how the project will adhere to that mission through features can help individuals remain engaged in the space and empower them to utilize all available health and wellness programs and policies.²⁵⁵ Multi-modal programming, educational materials and communications can help promote health literacy and increase positive health outcomes.^{256,257} By supporting awareness of health and wellness programs and policies, projects can promote health literacy and encourage engagement with health resources, leading to both individual benefits - like increased participation in healthy behaviors and use of health services - and also employer benefits, providing an estimated 4:1 return on investment.^{253,258}

Part 1 Promote Health-Oriented Mission (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization establishes a health-oriented mission that meets the following requirements:

- a. Connects supporting and improving occupant health to the organizational objectives or mission statement.
- b. Outlines the project's or organization's objectives for health promotion.

Part 2 Provide Feature Guide and Occupant Communication (Max: 0 Pt)

For All Spaces:

A physical or digital WELL feature guide, such as the WELL report, will be prominently displayed and/or made widely available to all occupants upon certification achievement or completion of a review cycle, meeting the following requirements:

- a. Describes the WELL features achieved by the project or organization.

The following requirement is met:

- a. Quarterly communications (e.g., emails, modules, trainings) are sent to regular occupants, and onboarding communications are given to new employees (as applicable), about health resources, programs, amenities and policies available to them addressed by the WELL features achieved by the project or organization.